

The benefits of eating well

Eating healthy gives a teen more energy, better concentration, and a general sense of well-being. It's easy for teens to take small steps to improve their diet.

Healthy habits

There are lots of things teens can do to make sure they are eating healthy. Here are just a few.



△ Staying hydrated

Drinking 6–8 glasses of liquid per day is recommended. Water is best, so try to limit fruit juice and smoothies to half a cup (150ml) per day.



△ Eating breakfast

Breakfast means “breaking the fast” after a night’s sleep. It energizes the brain and body ready for the day ahead.



△ Healthy snacking

Healthy snacks can be just as quick as sugary snacks to put together. They also keep the body feeling full longer.



△ Controlling portion size

For carbohydrates, proteins, and vegetables, a serving should measure about the size of a person's fist.



△ Dining regularly

To sustain the body throughout the day, eat meals and snacks at regular times.



△ Getting enough fruits and vegetables

Eat a selection of 3–6 cups fruits and vegetables every day.

Not so healthy

Teens should be conscious of unhealthy habits in their everyday diet. Having treats in moderation is the best way to stay healthy.

Fast food

Fast food can often be tasty and quick, but it's typically high in calories, saturated fat, salt, and sugar. Fast food should only be consumed as an occasional treat.

Sugary treats

Chocolate, ice cream, fizzy drinks, and sweets can seem a more appealing snack than healthy fruit. However, too much of these can increase the risk of diabetes, cause tooth decay, and lead to weight gain.

Detox diets

Teens should avoid diets encouraging them to “detox,” “cleanse,” or anything that recommends skipping meals or eating just one type of food. Dieting in this way can be dangerous, and may cause a teen to develop an eating disorder.